

New Carrier Checklist

Everything a new one-truck interstate carrier does to get legal, in the order it happens.

Fees below are the official government prices, verified September 2026.

BEFORE YOU APPLY

- ☐ Set up the business and lock the exact legal name
- ☐ Get your EIN from the IRS (free, online, minutes)
- ☐ Confirm what you need with FMCSA's own wizard
- ☐ Line up your insurance before you file

FEDERAL REGISTRATION (MOTUS)

- ☐ Create a Login.gov account and sign in to Motus
- ☐ Verify your identity - you, personally, on your phone
- ☐ Apply for your USDOT number (free)
- ☐ Apply for operating authority and pay the \$300
- ☐ Your insurer files the BMC-91 or BMC-91X
- ☐ A process agent files your BOC-3
- ☐ Watch for ACTIVE - then you can haul for hire
- ☐ Register with UCR (annual)

TAXES, PLATES AND FUEL

- ☐ File IRS Form 2290 (heavy vehicle use tax)
- ☐ Get apportioned plates (IRP) from your base state
- ☐ Get your IFTA license and decals
- ☐ Five states charge by the mile - register first

LEGAL ON THE ROAD

- ☐ Join a drug and alcohol testing consortium
- ☐ Register in the Clearinghouse and query yourself
- ☐ Put a registered ELD in the truck (unless exempt)
- ☐ Build your paperwork file
- ☐ Know what a roadside inspection checks
- ☐ Pass the New Entrant safety audit in year one
- ☐ Get your first load - and get paid

What the government actually charges

USDOT number	FMCSA	\$0
Operating authority (property carrier)	FMCSA, via Pay.gov	\$300 one time
BOC-3 process agent filing	A private process agent	About \$35-\$75 one time
UCR registration, 1-2 trucks	UCR national registration	\$46/yr (2026), \$55 (2027)
Drug and alcohol consortium	A private consortium	About \$66-\$85 a year
Clearinghouse query	FMCSA Clearinghouse	\$1.25 each
Heavy vehicle use tax, 80,000 lb truck	IRS Form 2290	\$550 a year
Biennial update (MCS-150)	FMCSA	\$0

The full walkthrough, with the click path for every step: haullegal.com

The first four steps are free to read at haullegal.com/start. The deadline calculator at haullegal.com/calendar is free to use: enter your USDOT number and a few dates and it works out your biennial update, IFTA quarters, UCR, Form 2290, medical card and inspections. Rules and fees change - always confirm on the agency page before you file.

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